KloDock

Desktop GUI for OpenClaw

Zero terminal. Zero complexity.

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MIT License

1. Overview

KloDock is a native desktop application that wraps the open-source OpenClaw AI agent framework in a visual, point-and-click interface. OpenClaw is one of the most capable open-source agent platforms available, but it demands terminal fluency, manual JSON and Markdown configuration, and comfortable API key management — skills that put it out of reach for most non-technical users.

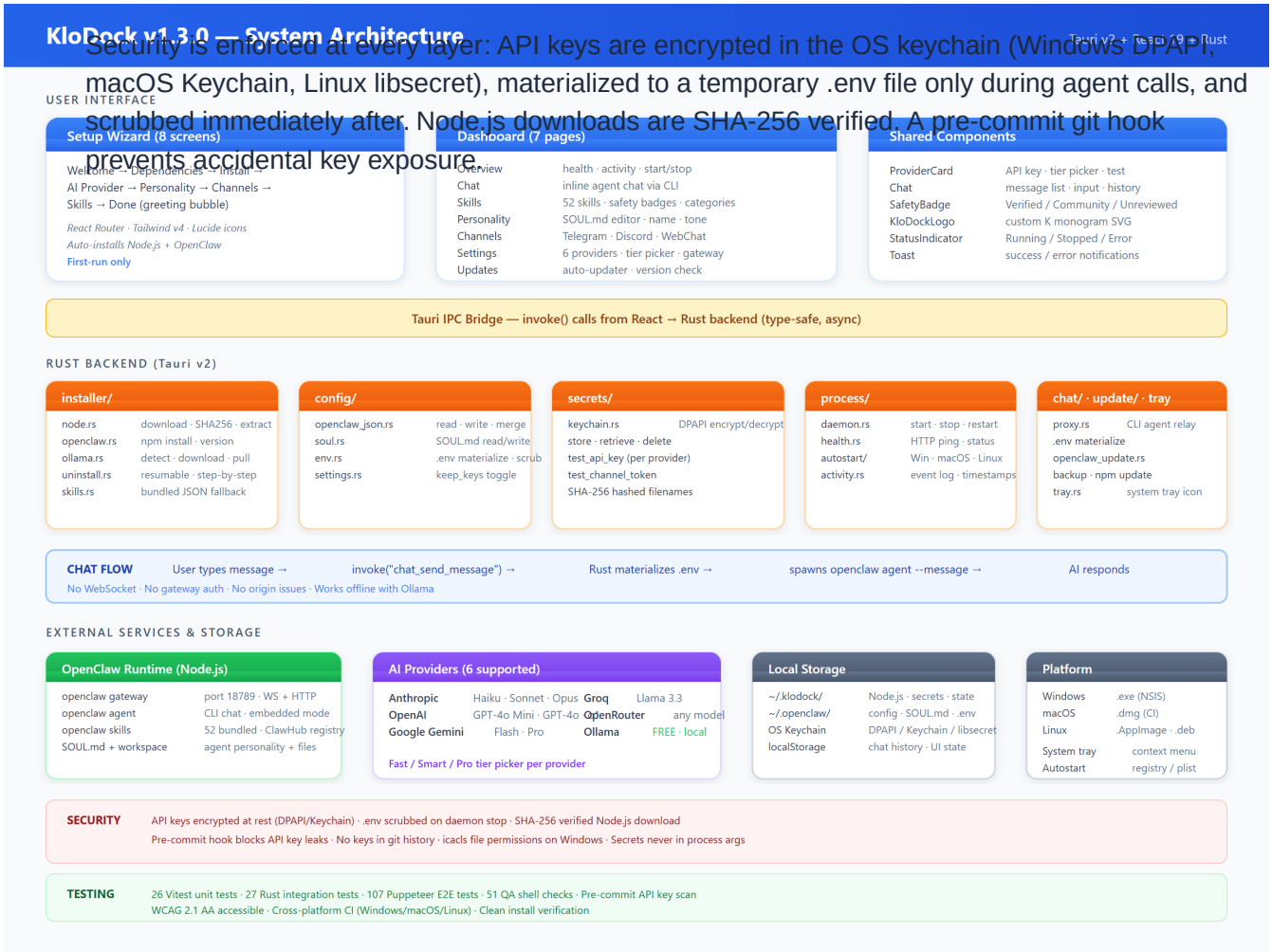
KloDock fills that gap. It packages the entire OpenClaw setup and management lifecycle into a guided wizard that takes minutes, not hours, from download to a running agent. There is no command line, no config file editing, and no Markdown to write. The user downloads a lightweight installer, runs the wizard, and talks to their agent.

Everything stays local: keys are stored in the operating system's native credential store, the agent process runs on the user's machine, and no data leaves the device except what the user's chosen AI provider requires.

System Architecture

KloDock is built on four layers: a React frontend rendered in a Tauri webview, a Rust backend that handles all system operations, the OpenClaw agent runtime (Node.js), and external AI providers. All communication between layers uses type-safe Tauri IPC calls — no HTTP servers, no WebSocket protocols, no origin headers.

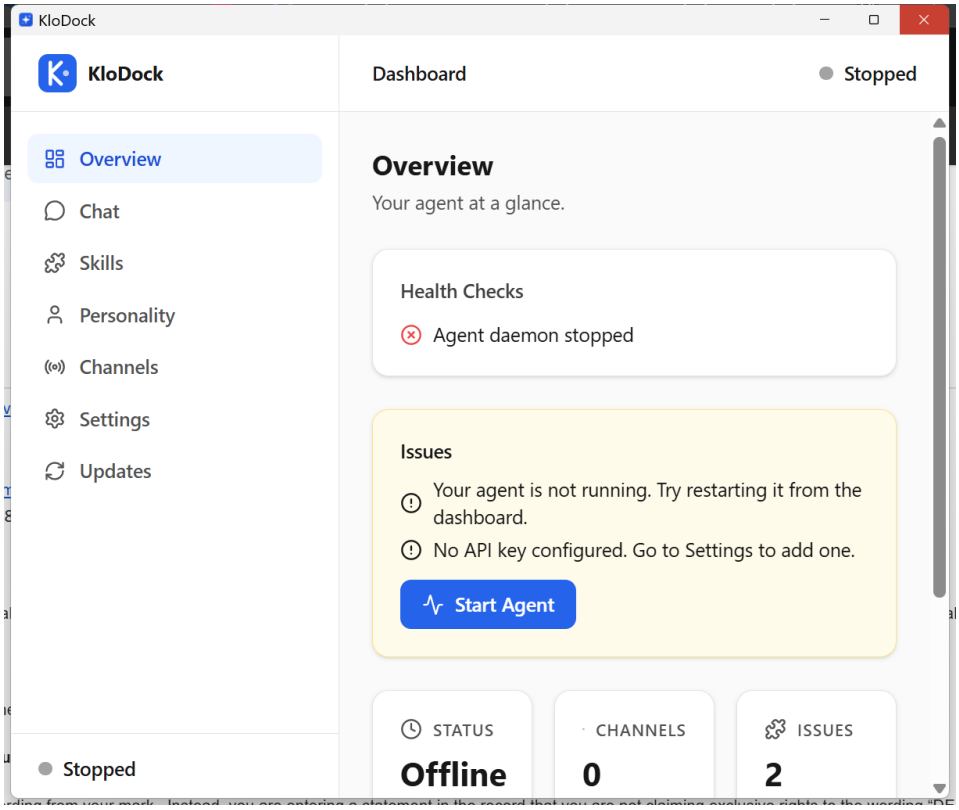
The chat interface uses a direct CLI approach: user messages are passed to the OpenClaw agent command as a child process, which calls the AI provider and returns the response. This eliminates the gateway authentication complexity entirely.



Security is enforced at every layer: API keys are encrypted in the OS keychain (Windows DPAPI, macOS Keychain, Linux libsecret), materialized to a temporary .env file only during agent calls, and scrubbed immediately after. Node.js downloads are SHA-256 verified. A pre-commit git hook prevents accidental key exposure.

2. Key Features

- 7-step setup wizard — From download to a running AI agent in minutes, not hours. No terminal, no manual steps.
- Silent Node.js installation — Detects existing installs, nvm, Volta, Homebrew. Silently downloads v24.14.0 if needed.
- Visual personality builder — Name, role templates, tone slider, live SOUL.md preview.
- Secure API key management — OS credential store (DPAPI, Keychain, libsecret). Keys never in plaintext.
- Ollama integration — Auto-detection, model listing, model picker. Free, local AI with no API key needed.
- Channel setup — Guided Telegram and Discord configuration with token validation.
- 52 categorized skills — 8 categories with search, filtering, and actionable setup buttons.
- Full management dashboard — 6 pages: Overview, Skills, Personality, Channels, Settings, Updates.
- Auto-updater — Checks npm registry for latest OpenClaw, one-click "Update now" button.
- Toast notification system — Global success, error, warning, and info feedback.
- Daemon auto-restart — Automatic recovery with backoff (up to 3 attempts).
- Start on login — Optional system tray launcher (registry/launch agent/XDG).
- Clean uninstall — Resumable 7-step process, user data preserved by default.
- Accessible — WCAG 2.1 AA, keyboard navigation, screen reader tested.



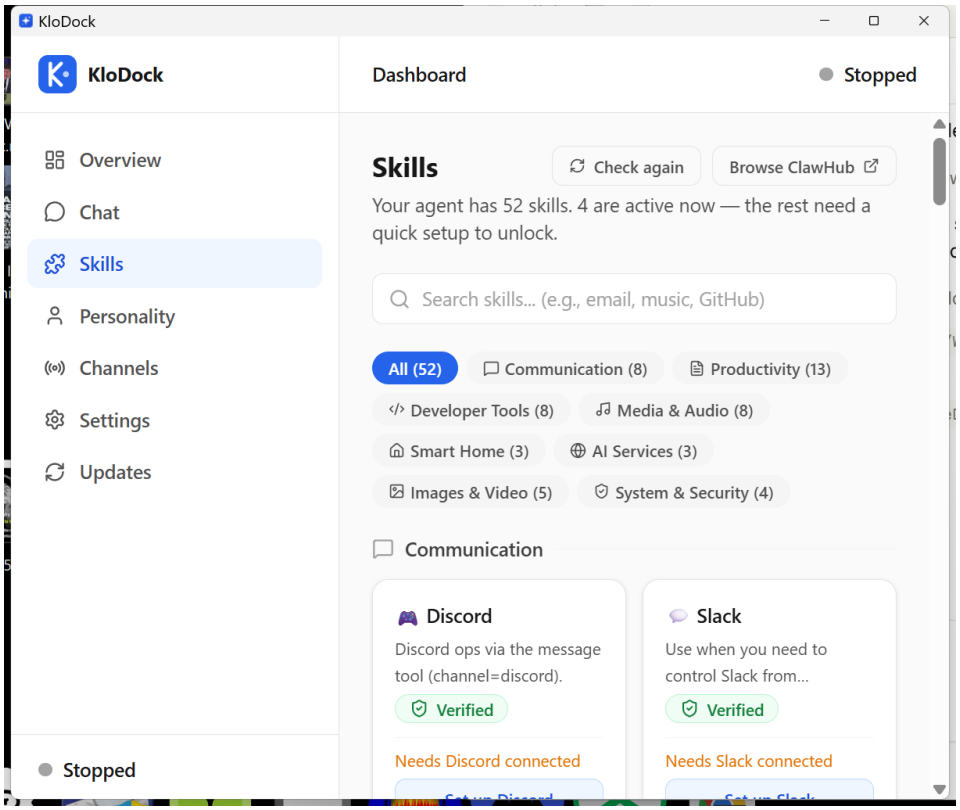
Dashboard Overview — Health checks, agent status, and quick actions

3. Dashboard

KloDock's dashboard provides full management of your AI agent without ever touching a config file. Every setting that can be configured in the setup wizard is also editable from the dashboard.

Skills

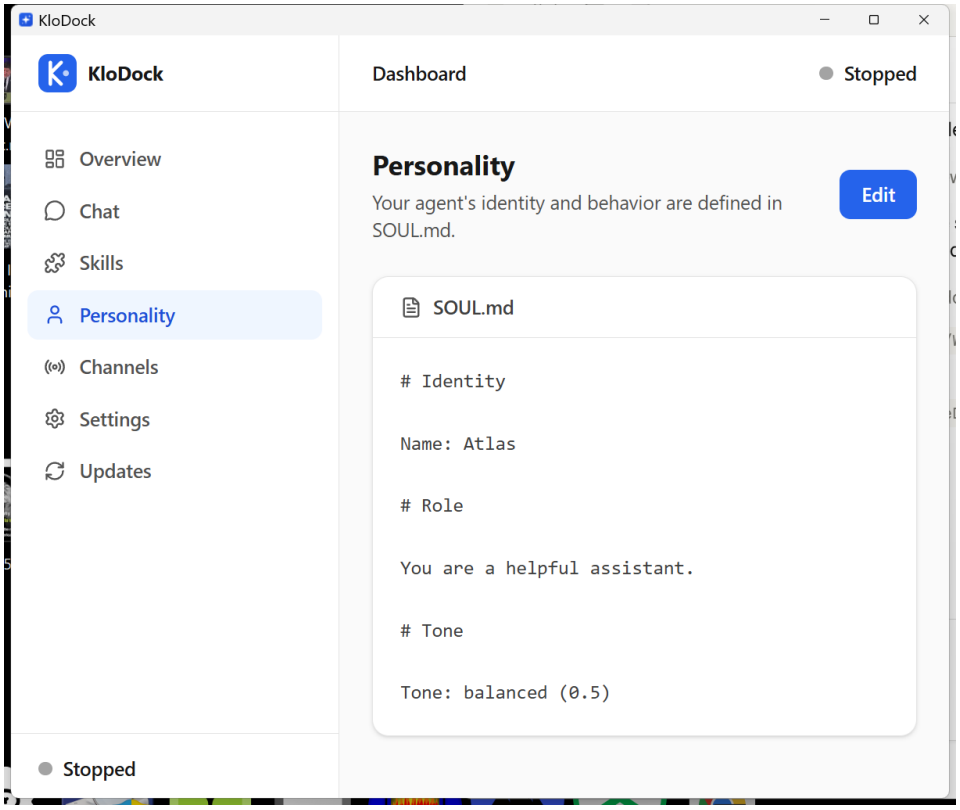
52 bundled skills organized into 8 categories: Communication, Productivity, Developer Tools, Media & Audio, Smart Home, AI Services, Images & Video, and System & Security. Active skills show a green badge. Unavailable skills show exactly what's needed with a download link or navigation button. Search and category filters help you find what you need.



Skills Browser — Search, filter by category, and see what each skill needs

Personality

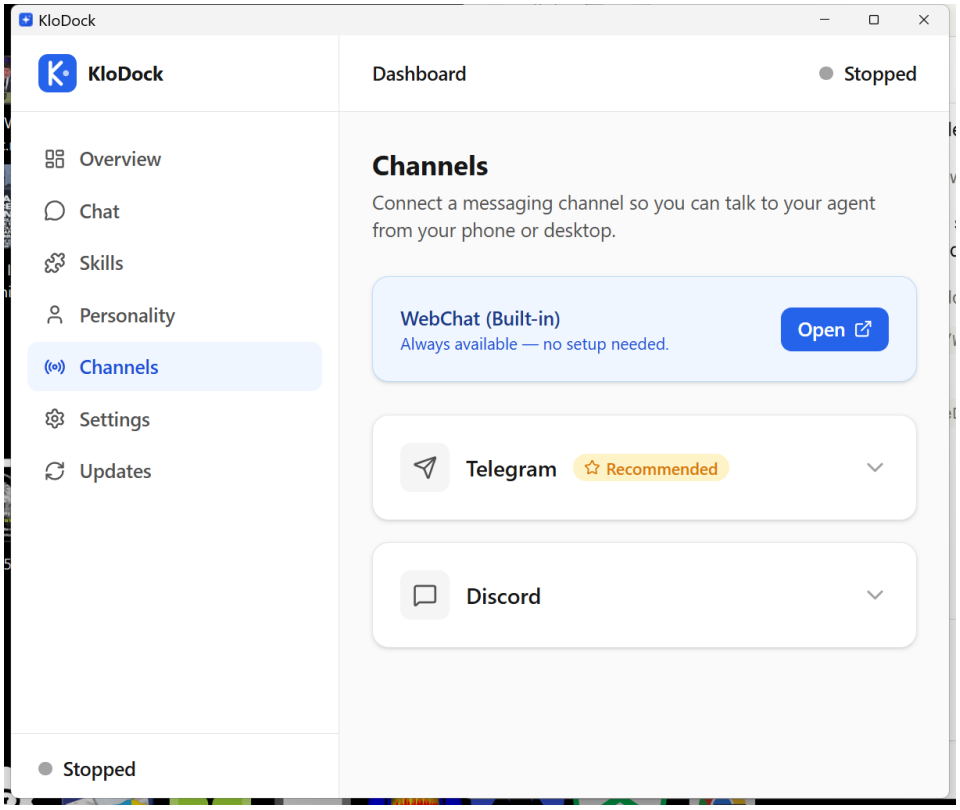
View and edit your agent's identity inline. Change the name, role, tone, and special instructions, then see a live SOUL.md preview before saving.



Personality Editor — Name, role, tone slider, and SOUL.md preview

Channels

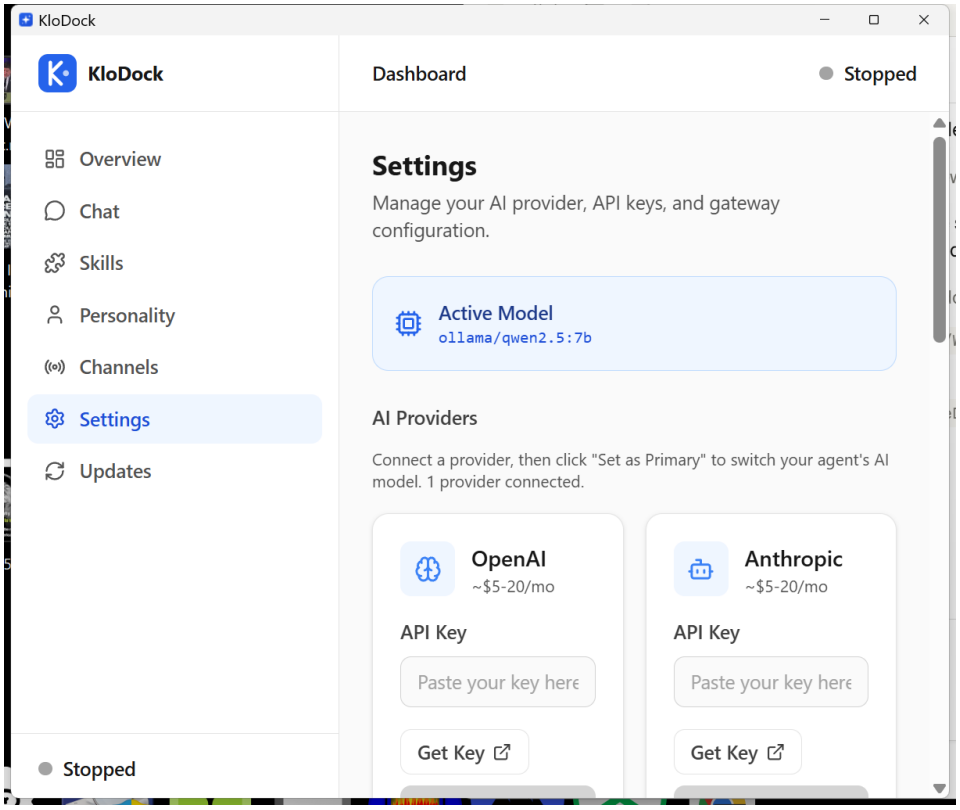
Connect messaging channels with step-by-step guides. WebChat is always available. Telegram and Discord have expandable setup flows with token validation, save, and disconnect.



Channel Setup — WebChat built-in, Telegram and Discord with guided setup

Settings

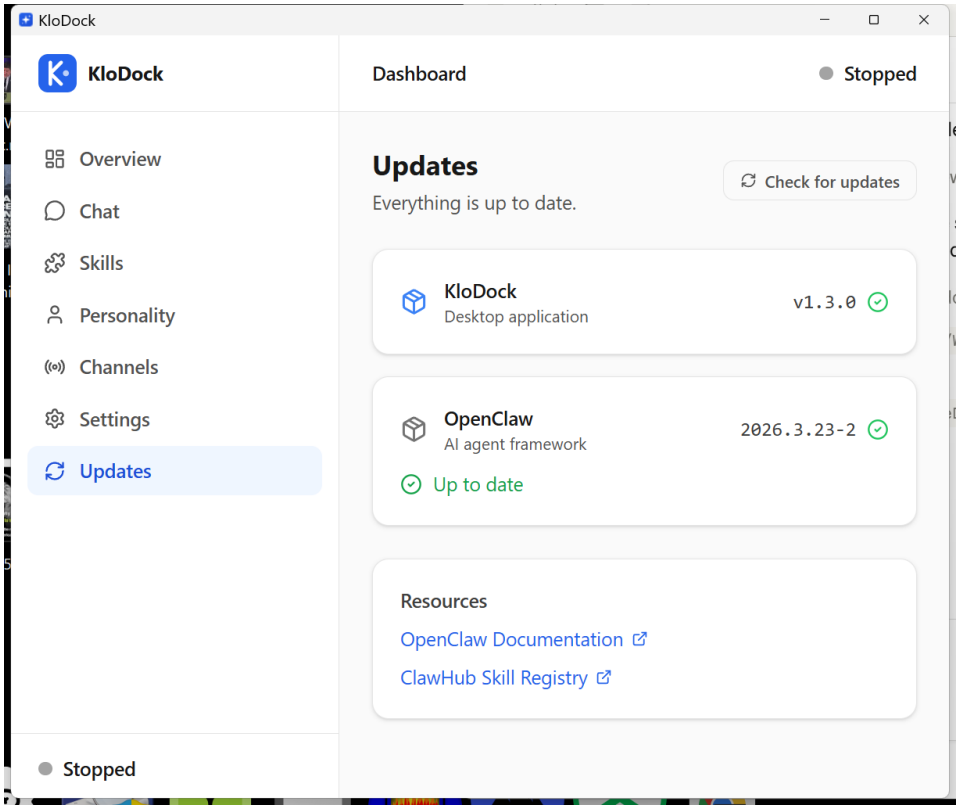
Full AI provider management with the same card grid from the setup wizard. Switch providers with "Set as Primary," manage API keys, configure the gateway port and auth mode. Includes a Danger Zone with one-click uninstall.



AI Provider Settings — Connect, switch, and manage providers

Updates

Real-time version checking against the npm registry. Shows current vs. latest version with a clear "Up to date" or "Update now" button.



Update Manager — Version check with one-click update

4. Security Model

KloDock treats API keys as the most sensitive data in the system. Keys are stored in the OS credential store (DPAPI on Windows, Keychain on macOS, libsecret on Linux) and never exist in plaintext at rest.

- Ephemeral .env — Written only while the daemon runs, scrubbed on stop and on every launch.
- Crash recovery scrub — On every launch, removes any stale .env from a prior crash.
- SHA256 verification — Node.js downloads verified against official checksums.
- Tauri capabilities — Frontend restricted to registered IPC commands only.
- Ollama zero-key path — No API key stored, no .env created, no credentials anywhere.
- No telemetry — No usage data collected or transmitted by default.

5. Tech Stack

Layer	Choice

Desktop framework | Tauri v2 (Rust backend, system webview)
Frontend | React 19 + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS v4
Routing | React Router v7
Icons | Lucide React
Secret storage | DPAPI (Win), Keychain (macOS), libsecret (Linux)
Testing | Vitest + Cargo test + WebdriverIO E2E
CI/CD | GitHub Actions (cross-platform)

6. Competitive Positioning

Product	Price / Local / GUI / Terminal
KloDock	Free / Local / Yes / No
OpenClaw CLI	Free / Local / No / Yes
Clawnify	$20+/mo / Cloud / Yes / No
OneClaw	$10/mo / Cloud / Yes / No
KiwiClaw	$15-39/mo / Cloud / Yes / No

KloDock occupies the unique position of being both free and easy to use while keeping all data local.

7. License

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